SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #9 · CHRIST

# “Jesus doesn’t understand what I’m going through.”

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## Where it often comes from

Pictures of Jesus as calm, untouched, and far above ordinary struggles. Being told to “just have faith” when you were hurting. Pain that feels unique, such as loss, abuse, illness, or loneliness. People in your life who did not understand you, so you assume no one can. Thinking of Jesus’ divinity while forgetting His full humanity.

## What Scripture teaches

Jesus is fully God and fully man. He was tired, hungry, rejected, misunderstood, betrayed, and grieved. He wept at a friend’s grave and was overwhelmed with sorrow in Gethsemane. He was tempted in every way we are. Because He suffered, He is able to help you. He does not look down on your pain from a distance; He has been there.

> *“For we do not have a high priest who is unable to sympathize with our weaknesses, but we have one who was tempted in every way that we are, yet was without sin”* **(Hebrews 4:15)**.

## Also see

> “He was despised and rejected by men, a man of sorrows, acquainted with grief. Like one from whom men hide their faces, He was despised, and we esteemed Him not” **(Isaiah 53:3)**.

> “Because He Himself suffered when He was tempted, He is able to help those who are being tempted” **(Hebrews 2:18)**.

> “Jesus wept” **(John 11:35)**.

> “Then He said to them, ‘My soul is consumed with sorrow to the point of death. Stay here and keep watch with Me.’” **(Matthew 26:38)**.

## Common self-statements

- Nobody understands what this is like.
- Jesus never had to deal with anything like this.
- He’s God, so it was easy for Him.
- My pain is too unusual for Him to relate to.
- He’s disappointed that I’m struggling.
- I have to go through this alone.

## Common logical errors

- **Overgeneralization:** Turning “some people didn’t understand me” into “no one, not even Jesus, can.”
- **Discounting the positive:** Overlooking what the Gospels show about Jesus’ own suffering.
- **Emotional reasoning:** Concluding “I feel alone, so I must be alone.”
- **Projection:** Assuming Jesus responds to pain the way unkind people in your life did.
- **Magnification:** Seeing your pain as so unique that no one could relate.

## Challenging questions

- What did Jesus experience: rejection, grief, betrayal, temptation, physical pain?
- Was Jesus' suffering easy because He was God, or was it real?
- If He was tempted in every way, what part of my struggle is outside His experience?
- Whose lack of understanding am I really remembering?
- Why would Jesus weep with Mary if He did not care about grief?
- What would change if I believed He truly understands?
- Have I told Him honestly what I am going through?

## Truth summary

> Jesus understands. He knows rejection, grief, betrayal, temptation, and pain from the inside. He is not ashamed of my weakness and does not look down on my struggle. Because He suffered, He is able to help me, and I can bring Him exactly what I am feeling.

## Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Christ, Humanity of
- Christ, Personality of
- Suffering
- Grief
- Loneliness

## Listen: Overcoming Depression

**Overcoming Depression** · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

*Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"*

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

# My Plan for Replacing "Jesus doesn't understand what I'm going through"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

**Name:** _____ **Date started:** _____

## 1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

*Rate it now so you can see your progress later.*

**"Jesus doesn't understand what I'm going through."** I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

## 2 My best question

*The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.*

- ☐ What did Jesus suffer that I forget about?
- ☐ Was His suffering real, or easy because He was God?
- ☐ What part of my struggle is outside His experience?
- ☐ Whose lack of understanding am I remembering?
- ☐ Why would Jesus weep if He didn't care?
- ☐ Have I told Him honestly how I feel?

**My own question:** _____

## 3 My replacement truth

*The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.*

- ☐ Jesus understands my weakness from the inside.
- ☐ Jesus knows grief, rejection, and pain.
- ☐ Because He suffered, He is able to help me.
- ☐ I am not alone in this; He has been here.
- ☐ I can tell Jesus exactly what I am feeling.
- ☐ Jesus is not ashamed of my struggle.

**In my own words:** _____

## 4 My Scripture

*The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.*

- [ ] **Hebrews 4:15**
  *"For we do not have a high priest who is unable to sympathize with our weaknesses, but we have one who was tempted in every way that we are, yet was without sin."*
- [ ] **Isaiah 53:3**
  *"He was despised and rejected by men, a man of sorrows, acquainted with grief. Like one from whom men hide their faces, He was despised, and we esteemed Him not."*
- [ ] **Hebrews 2:18**
  *"Because He Himself suffered when He was tempted, He is able to help those who are being tempted."*
- [ ] **John 11:35**
  *"Jesus wept."*
- [ ] **Matthew 26:38**
  *"Then He said to them, 'My soul is consumed with sorrow to the point of death. Stay here and keep watch with Me.'"*

**A verse I found myself:** _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

# Practicing the Truth

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## 5 My practice plan

*Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.*

### EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

### PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Gospel log:** Each day, read a short passage from the Gospels and write one way Jesus experienced something I am feeling.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, Hebrews 2:18 becomes: "Because He Himself suffered when He was tempted, He is able to help **Sarah** when **she** is being tempted."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Christ, Humanity of" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

## 6 My action step this week

*Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.*

- ☐ **Write a list** of everything Jesus suffered in the Gospels, then circle anything that matches your own experience.
- ☐ **Tell Jesus honestly,** in your own words, exactly what you are going through, without dressing it up.
- ☐ **Read John 11:1–44 slowly,** noticing how Jesus responds to Mary and Martha's grief.
- ☐ **Share your struggle with one safe person,** and notice whether being understood helps.

**What I will do:** _____

**When:** _____

**What the lie predicts will happen:** _____

## 7 End-of-week check-in

*Bring this page to your next session.*

**What actually happened:** _____

What I learned: _____

**The lie** "Jesus doesn't understand what I'm going through": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

## Daily practice tracker

| Day | Read my card | Said my verse | Used my reminder | One way Jesus understands |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mon | | | | |
| Tue | | | | |
| Wed | | | | |
| Thu | | | | |
| Fri | | | | |
| Sat | | | | |
| Sun | | | | |

## My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Jesus doesn't understand what I'm going through.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

*Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.*

## Prayer

*Lord Jesus, thank You that You became fully human and know my weakness from the inside. Help me reject the lie that You do not understand what I am going through. Thank You for weeping, for grieving, and for being tempted as I am. I bring You my pain just as it is, and I trust You to help me. In Your name, Amen.*

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*Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.*